

Test Your *Idea* Before You *Build*.

Avoid costly mistakes by validating your startup with a simple 7-step process.





Introduction

Every founder has ideas — but not all ideas are worth building. The harsh truth?

Most startups fail not because they couldn't build, but because they built something nobody wanted.

At AVS, we believe in starting smart. Before you spend money on developers, branding, or marketing, take a few simple steps to test if your idea solves a real problem — for real people — in the real world.

This playbook walks you through a lean, proven process to validate your idea without writing a single line of code. Whether you're a first-time founder or launching your fifth venture, these steps will help you avoid costly mistakes and build something people are actually waiting for.

Let's help you figure out if you're on the right track — before you go all in.

1

Talk to 30 Humans

Find your audience in Slack, Reddit, LinkedIn, WhatsApp, or Discord. Start real conversations. Ask:

- “What’s frustrating about [X]?”
- “Tried fixing it? What worked?”
- “How are you managing it now?”

Tools



2

Spot the Pain

Review your conversations and identify recurring frustrations, challenges, or inefficiencies. Boil each down into a one-sentence insight.

How to do it:

- Use a spreadsheet with columns for Name and three pain points.
- Use tally marks to track frequency
- Look for common language across interviews



3

Define the Value

Now that you understand the pain, articulate your proposed solution in one sentence. This becomes the core of your messaging going forward.

How to do it:

- Use the format: "We help [X] solve [Y] by [Z]."
- Say it out loud to someone new—do they get it without asking questions?
- Keep refining until it's crisp, compelling, and clear.

4

Sketch a Landing Page

Design a simple landing page that describes your solution. This gives people something tangible to react to, and it forces you to communicate value clearly.

Draft a simple page with:

- 1 headline (the pain)
- 1 subhead (your solution)
- 1 call-to-action (e.g., "Join Waitlist")

5

Call Every Sign-Up

This is where you uncover emotional triggers and real motivations. Their answers will help you refine your messaging, feature set, and offer.

Bonus Questions to Ask:

- What problem were you hoping this would solve?
- What are you using now?
- How would your life or work improve if this existed?

6

Iterate & Retest

Iteration is where weak ideas are sharpened or dropped. Data + conversation = direction.

Suggestions for Iteration:

- Try a different headline.
- Focus on a new pain point.
- Change your CTA from "Get Early Access" to "Request a Demo".

7

Measure & Decide

This is your go/no-go signal. If the numbers look good and conversations are enthusiastic, move forward. If not, pivot or scrap the idea.

Review your key metrics:

- Is click-through rate (CTR) above 2%?
- Are sign-ups increasing?
- Are demo requests coming in?

Final Thoughts

Validating early can save you months of wasted time and thousands in development costs. You don't need a perfect product — just a real problem and the willingness to test quickly.

Do this first. Build second

